

Apartment 4B: deposit and ceiling repair

Text message report

PREPARED BY	Sam
PREPARED ON	September 29, 2026 at 2:50 PM PDT
MESSAGES IN THIS REPORT	49 total: 14 matching the search, 35 shown for context (3 before and after each match)
DATE RANGE	November 3, 2025 – June 27, 2026
PARTICIPANTS	Sam (23), Dana Whitfield (19), Priya Shah (7)
WORDS	“deposit ceiling” (any of the words)

Messages are reproduced as stored on the device. Reference numbers (M-0001...) identify each message in this report and match the accompanying spreadsheet.

1. Source and method

SOURCE	Demo data: fictional messages generated by <code>imsg/demo.py</code> . Not a real device.
DATABASE FINGERPRINT	SHA-256 94e5174027c2365ace5c89235830d84f982204ffda123fe2b11bb23fa4a72f74 A fingerprint of the exact copy of the Messages database this report was made from. Any change to that file changes the fingerprint.
SEARCH INDEX BUILT	Sep 29, 2026, 2:50 PM
TIMES	Shown in the Mac's local time zone (America/Los_Angeles), adjusted for daylight saving time.
WHAT'S INCLUDED	Message text exactly as stored. Tapback reactions are left out. Attachments are listed by file name; their contents aren't included. Messages marked ★ matched the search; the others are the surrounding conversation, included for context.
PREPARED WITH	iMessage Search (github.com/marianina8/imessage-search)

2. Summary

AI-GENERATED SUMMARY

Written by Claude (claude-sonnet-5-5) on September 29, 2026 from the 49 messages in this report, focusing on: "What happened with the deposit and the bathroom ceiling?". It's a reading aid, not evidence or legal advice. Check each point against the cited messages.

Overview

Sam (the tenant) and landlord Dana Whitfield exchanged messages about a recurring leak in the bathroom ceiling from November 2025 to January 2026, and later about the security deposit after Sam and roommate Priya moved out on May 29, 2026. Dana kept \$1,150 of the \$2,400 deposit for a ceiling repair and cleaning [M-0016, M-0038]. Sam disputes both charges [M-0039, M-0040].

Key points

- Dana withheld **\$1,150**: "\$900 for the bathroom ceiling repair and \$250 for cleaning," and wrote that a \$1,250 refund was mailed on June 18, 2026 [M-0038].
- Sam reported the leak with photos on November 3, 2025 [M-0001] and again on December 14, 2025, noting the stain was bigger [M-0007]. Dana replied within hours both times [M-0002, M-0008].
- Dana wrote that the plumber "can't come until January" [M-0011]. On January 9, 2026, she wrote that the seal and the ceiling drywall had been replaced [M-0012].
- Dana wrote on November 6, 2025 that she would get the ceiling "patched and painted" [M-0006]. On March 15, 2026, Sam wrote that it had never been painted, and Dana replied she would take care of it before new tenants arrived [M-0018, M-0019].
- Dana asked for professional cleaning at move-out [M-0016]. Sam wrote that cleaners came and that the receipt was sent on May 29 [M-0040]. Priya's messages say the cleaners cost \$320 and that she paid Sam half [M-0022, M-0024, M-0026].
- Dana wrote that the ceiling "got worse because you didn't report the leak fast enough" [M-0041]. Sam replied that both reports were sent the same day [M-0042].
- Sam wrote that the itemized ceiling invoice is dated January 9 [M-0047].

Timeline

- **Nov 3, 2025**: Sam reports the leak with a photo [M-0001]. Dana says the plumber will come Thursday [M-0002].
- **Nov 6, 2025**: Dana: tub seal fixed "for now"; ceiling will be patched and painted [M-0004, M-0006].
- **Dec 14, 2025**: Sam reports the leak is back and the stain is bigger [M-0007, M-0009].
- **Dec 19, 2025**: Dana: the plumber can't come until January [M-0011].
- **Jan 9, 2026**: Dana: seal and drywall replaced; painting next week [M-0012].

- **Feb 2, 2026:** Sam gives notice. Dana asks for professional cleaning and states the deposit is \$2,400 [M-0014, M-0016].
- **Mar 15, 2026:** Sam notes the ceiling was never painted [M-0018].
- **May 29, 2026:** Sam says a video of every room was taken at move-out [M-0033].
- **Jun 1, 2026:** Dana: walkthrough "looks mostly good" [M-0035].
- **Jun 18, 2026:** Dana withholds \$1,150 [M-0038]. Sam disputes it [M-0039, M-0040].
- **Jun 27, 2026:** Dana sends the itemized list [M-0046]. Sam points to the January 9 invoice date [M-0047].

Statements by participant

Dana Whitfield

- Said she would have the ceiling "patched and painted" [M-0006] and would handle it before new tenants [M-0019].
- Described the walkthrough as "mostly good" [M-0035].
- Attributed the ceiling damage to late reporting [M-0041]. Later wrote, "I'll need to look at my records" [M-0043].
- Asked to "talk on the phone" [M-0048].

Sam

- Reported the leak on November 3 and December 14, 2025, each with a photo [M-0001, M-0007].
- Said the apartment was professionally cleaned and the receipt was sent [M-0040].
- Asked for an itemized list with receipts [M-0044] and asked to keep the discussion in writing [M-0049].

Priya Shah

- Wrote that cleaners cost \$320 [M-0026] and that she sent Sam \$160 [M-0024].
- Wrote that "the ceiling was her leak" [M-0027].

Ambiguities and gaps

- The cleaning receipt, the move-out video, the photos, and Dana's itemized list are referenced but their contents aren't in these messages [M-0029, M-0033, M-0040, M-0046].
- Whether the ceiling was painted before move-out isn't stated after March 15, 2026 [M-0019].
- Nothing here shows whether Dana's January 9 invoice covers the same repair as the \$900 charge. Sam says it does [M-0047]; Dana's reply isn't in writing [M-0048].
- Dana wrote that the refund was mailed [M-0038]. There's no message confirming it was received.

3. Index of matching messages

REF	DATE	SENDER	MESSAGE
M-0001	Nov 3, 2025, 9:12 AM	Sam	Hi Dana, water is dripping from the bathroom ceiling again. Photos attached.
M-0005	Nov 6, 2025, 5:07 PM	Sam	Thanks! The ceiling paint is bubbling though. Will that get repaired?
M-0007	Dec 14, 2025, 10:22 AM	Sam	Hi Dana, the leak is back and the stain on the bathroom ceiling is bigger.
M-0012	Jan 9, 2026, 2:30 PM	Dana Whitfield	Mike replaced the seal and the drywall in the bathroom ceiling. Painting next week.
M-0016	Feb 2, 2026, 8:03 PM	Dana Whitfield	Please have it cleaned professionally when you leave. The deposit is \$2,400.
M-0018	Mar 15, 2026, 11:00 AM	Sam	By the way, the bathroom ceiling was never painted. It still has the patch.
M-0025	Jun 18, 2026, 3:45 PM	Sam	Dana is keeping \$1,150 of the deposit, including \$250 for cleaning!
M-0027	Jun 18, 2026, 3:48 PM	Priya Shah	and the ceiling was her leak
M-0031	Jun 27, 2026, 3:42 PM	Sam	yes. the ceiling invoice is from January, before we moved out
M-0036	Jun 1, 2026, 10:50 AM	Sam	Great. When should we expect the deposit?
M-0038	Jun 18, 2026, 3:32 PM	Dana Whitfield	I'm keeping \$1,150 of the deposit: \$900 for the bathroom ceiling repair and \$250 for cleaning. The \$1,250 refund was mailed today.
M-0039	Jun 18, 2026, 3:40 PM	Sam	The ceiling damage came from the leak you were fixing. We reported it in November and again in December.
M-0041	Jun 18, 2026, 4:55 PM	Dana Whitfield	The ceiling got worse because you didn't report the leak fast enough.
M-0047	Jun 27, 2026, 2:50 PM	Sam	The ceiling invoice is dated January 9. That's the repair from the leak, months before we moved out.

4. Messages

★ **Highlighted** messages matched the search. The others are the conversation around them.

Excerpt 1 · Dana Whitfield · Nov 3, 2025, 9:12 AM – Apr 10, 2026, 9:20 AM

M-0001 ★	Nov 3, 2025, 9:12:00 AM	Sam: Hi Dana, water is dripping from the bathroom ceiling again. Photos attached. <i>Attachment: IMG_2041.HEIC</i>
M-0002	Nov 3, 2025, 9:40:00 AM	Dana Whitfield: Ugh, sorry. I'll have Mike the plumber come by Thursday.
M-0003	Nov 3, 2025, 9:41:00 AM	Sam: Thursday works. Priya will be home to let him in.
M-0004	Nov 6, 2025, 5:05:00 PM	Dana Whitfield: Mike says it's the seal on the upstairs tub. Fixed for now.
M-0005 ★	Nov 6, 2025, 5:07:00 PM	Sam: Thanks! The ceiling paint is bubbling though. Will that get repaired?
M-0006	Nov 6, 2025, 5:30:00 PM	Dana Whitfield: Yes, I'll get it patched and painted. Don't worry about it.
M-0007 ★	Dec 14, 2025, 10:22:00 AM	Sam: Hi Dana, the leak is back and the stain on the bathroom ceiling is bigger. <i>Attachment: IMG_2107.HEIC</i>
M-0008	Dec 14, 2025, 12:48:00 PM	Dana Whitfield: I'm traveling until the 28th. Can it wait?
M-0009	Dec 14, 2025, 12:50:00 PM	Sam: It drips every time someone upstairs showers. We've put a bucket under it.
M-0010	Dec 14, 2025, 12:52:00 PM	Dana Whitfield: OK, I'll call Mike.
M-0011	Dec 19, 2025, 8:15:00 AM	Dana Whitfield: Mike can't come until January. Keep using the bucket, sorry.
M-0012 ★	Jan 9, 2026, 2:30:00 PM	Dana Whitfield: Mike replaced the seal and the drywall in the bathroom ceiling. Painting next week.
M-0013	Jan 9, 2026, 2:31:00 PM	Sam: Great, thank you.
M-0014	Feb 2, 2026, 7:10:00 PM	Sam: Hi Dana, a heads up that we won't renew. Our lease ends May 31 and we'll be out by then.
M-0015	Feb 2, 2026, 8:02:00 PM	Dana Whitfield: Thanks for letting me know. I'll start showing it in April.
M-0016 ★	Feb 2, 2026, 8:03:00 PM	Dana Whitfield: Please have it cleaned professionally when you leave. The deposit is \$2,400.
M-0017	Feb 2, 2026, 8:05:00 PM	Sam: Will do.
M-0018 ★	Mar 15, 2026, 11:00:00 AM	Sam: By the way, the bathroom ceiling was never painted. It still has the patch.
M-0019	Mar 15, 2026, 1:24:00 PM	Dana Whitfield: I'll take care of it before the new tenants move in.
M-0020	Apr 10, 2026, 9:05:00 AM	Dana Whitfield: Can I show the apartment Saturday at 11?
M-0021	Apr 10, 2026, 9:20:00 AM	Sam: Saturday at 11 is fine.

Excerpt 2 · Priya Shah · May 28, 2026, 9:00 PM – Jun 27, 2026, 3:43 PM

M-0022	May 28, 2026, 9:00:00 PM	Priya Shah: cleaners booked for tomorrow 10am, \$320. I'll venmo you half
M-0023	May 28, 2026, 9:02:00 PM	Sam: perfect thanks
M-0024	May 29, 2026, 1:00:00 PM	Priya Shah: sent you \$160 for the cleaners
M-0025 ★	Jun 18, 2026, 3:45:00 PM	Sam: Dana is keeping \$1,150 of the deposit, including \$250 for cleaning!
M-0026	Jun 18, 2026, 3:47:00 PM	Priya Shah: WHAT. we paid \$320 for professional cleaners
M-0027 ★	Jun 18, 2026, 3:48:00 PM	Priya Shah: and the ceiling was her leak
M-0028	Jun 18, 2026, 3:50:00 PM	Sam: I'm pulling all our texts together. You still have the photos from December?
M-0029	Jun 18, 2026, 3:52:00 PM	Priya Shah: yes, sending <i>Attachment: IMG_2110.HEIC</i>
M-0030	Jun 27, 2026, 3:40:00 PM	Priya Shah: did she send the itemized list?
M-0031 ★	Jun 27, 2026, 3:42:00 PM	Sam: yes. the ceiling invoice is from January, before we moved out
M-0032	Jun 27, 2026, 3:43:00 PM	Priya Shah: so she's charging us for her own repair?

Excerpt 3 · Dana Whitfield · May 29, 2026, 6:05 PM – Jun 27, 2026, 3:32 PM

M-0033	May 29, 2026, 6:05:00 PM	Sam: I'd prefer to be there. I took a video of every room today. <i>Attachment: Moveout_walkthrough.MOV</i>
M-0034	May 29, 2026, 6:30:00 PM	Dana Whitfield: Fine, Monday 10am.
M-0035	Jun 1, 2026, 10:48:00 AM	Dana Whitfield: Walkthrough done. Looks mostly good.
M-0036 ★	Jun 1, 2026, 10:50:00 AM	Sam: Great. When should we expect the deposit?
M-0037	Jun 1, 2026, 11:15:00 AM	Dana Whitfield: Within 21 days, per the law.
M-0038 ★	Jun 18, 2026, 3:32:00 PM	Dana Whitfield: I'm keeping \$1,150 of the deposit: \$900 for the bathroom ceiling repair and \$250 for cleaning. The \$1,250 refund was mailed today.
M-0039 ★	Jun 18, 2026, 3:40:00 PM	Sam: The ceiling damage came from the leak you were fixing. We reported it in November and again in December.
M-0040	Jun 18, 2026, 3:41:00 PM	Sam: And we had it professionally cleaned. I sent you the receipt on May 29.
M-0041 ★	Jun 18, 2026, 4:55:00 PM	Dana Whitfield: The ceiling got worse because you didn't report the leak fast enough.
M-0042	Jun 18, 2026, 4:58:00 PM	Sam: I texted you the same day both times. You said Mike couldn't come until January.
M-0043	Jun 18, 2026, 5:30:00 PM	Dana Whitfield: I'll need to look at my records.
M-0044	Jun 19, 2026, 9:10:00 AM	Sam: Can you send an itemized list with receipts for the \$1,150?

M-0045	Jun 25, 2026, 12:00:00 PM	Sam: Following up on the itemized list.
M-0046	Jun 27, 2026, 2:44:00 PM	Dana Whitfield: Attached. <i>Attachment: Deductions_itemized.pdf</i>
M-0047 ★	Jun 27, 2026, 2:50:00 PM	Sam: The ceiling invoice is dated January 9. That's the repair from the leak, months before we moved out.
M-0048	Jun 27, 2026, 3:30:00 PM	Dana Whitfield: Let's talk on the phone.
M-0049	Jun 27, 2026, 3:32:00 PM	Sam: I'd prefer to keep this in writing.